John Nga-Leong Koo

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international relations / foreign policy analysis / political methodology

Education

Harvard University — Cambridge, Mass., USA
PhD in Government — *Sep 2023 –*
Advisors: Alastair Iain Johnston, Joshua D. Kertzer
Graduate Student Associate, Weatherhead Center for International Affairs
Graduate Affiliate, Institute of Quantitative Social Science
Raymond Vernon Fellow

University of Hong Kong — Hong Kong
Bachelor of Laws & Bachelor of Social Sciences — *Aug 2018 – Jun 2023*
First-class honours
Dean's Honours List
HKU Worldwide Visiting Scholarship
Lee Shau Kee Scholarship

University of Oxford — Oxford, United Kingdom
Visiting Student in Politics — *Oct 2020 – Jul 2021*
First-class honours results
Specialisation in International Relations and Political Sociology

Publications

John Koo, Kai Quek. 2024. "Win-Win Deescalation." *International Studies Quarterly.* 68(4): sqae148.

Working Papers

"Breaking the Machine: Rise of Personalism and Foreign Policy Making"

"Repetition Premium"

"How Combat Experience Harms Promotion in Revolutionary Autocracies" (with Michael Cerny and Joshua Henderson)

"Reputations in Interaction" (with Kai Quek)
Presented at the Pacific International Politics Conference 2021, ISA 2021 (panel), and APSA 2022 (panel)

Research Experience

Research Assistant — Jul 2024 –
Stephen Walt — *Harvard Kennedy School*

Research Assistant — Jun 2024 –
Joshua Kertzer — *Harvard University*

Research Intern — May 2022 – Aug 2022
Dean Knox — *Wharton School*
Christopher Lucas — *Washington University in St. Louis*

Research Assistant — Jun 2020 – Jul 2023
Kai Quek — *University of Hong Kong*

Research Assistant — Jan 2022 – Jul 2023
Kelvin Kwok and Thomas Cheng — *University of Hong Kong*

Teaching

Harvard University
GOV 50 Data Science for the Social Sciences (Teaching Fellow, Fall 2025, with Scott Cunningham)

University of Hong Kong
POLI 2104 Research Methods in Politics and Public Administration (Teaching Assistant, Fall 2021, Fall 2022, with Kai Quek)

Competitive Grants and Fellowships

2025 Hans J. Morgenthau Fellow (Notre Dame International Security Center)
Weatherhead Graduate Student Associate

Workshops and Panel Presentations

2025 APSA (withdrawn)
2023 Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA), APSA
2022 International Studies Association (ISA), American Political Science Association (APSA)
2021 Pacific International Politics Conference (PIPC)

Service

For the Discipline

Referee for the *Journal of Politics*
Journal editor for the *Asia-Pacific Journal on Human Rights and the Law* (2019–2023)

For the Department

Harvard-MIT IR Summer Symposium (2024, 2025)
IR Research Workshop (2025, 2026)

For the Community

Director for the Outreach Legal Talks Initiative (2019–2022)
Mentor for PS-Prep (2024, 2025)

Skills

Languages: Cantonese (native), English (fluent), Mandarin (fluent), Japanese (JLPT N1)

Software: C/C++, R, Python, Julia, Stata, LaTeX, JavaScript, Ruby, Bash

Developer Tools: RStudio, GNU/C++, Git, Visual Studio Code

Reference

Alastair Iain Johnston
Governor James Albert Noe and Linda Noe Laine
Professor of China in World Affairs
Department of Government,
Harvard University

Tel: (617) 496-3965
Email: johnston@fas.harvard.edu

Joshua D. Kertzer
John Zwaanstra Professor of International Studies
and of Government
Department of Government,
Harvard University

Tel: (617) 384-7231
Email: jkertzer@gov.harvard.edu

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